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Technology Policy in the News: Policy Analysis of the European Union Artificial Intelligence Act

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Introduction and Status

The European Union Artificial Intelligence Act (EU AI ACT), Regulation (EU) 2024,1689, establishes rules the development and uses of article intelligence. Its purpose is to encourage trustworthy AI without unfriending people fundamental rights, safety, and health. The act is a risk-based approach meaning that it differs depending on the potential effects. The regulation entered into force on August 1, 2024, with requirements being implemented in stages. The act was amended in July of 2026 through regulation (EU) 2026/1744, also known as the Digital Omnibus on AI.

Coverage Analysis

The Reuters Article by Chee (2026), "EU tech chief says bloc is well equipped to fend of rouge ai risk" talks about the European Union's ability to address the risk factors associated with AI. They report that Eu officials believe the act can address risks that happen in a AI models lifecycle. It also mentions that more than thirty requests have been sent to 30 AI companies concerning safety, security, transparency, and copyrights. Even though the article provides a current perspective, its claims must match what the legislation claims. For instance, the act differentiates that the same requirements do not apply to every organization.

Stakeholder Analysis

The EU AI Act has many stakeholders as everyone has their own interest and responsibility. These are EU regulators, AI Developers, tech companies, organizations that deploy AI agents and systems, Cybersecurity professionals, and everyday citizens. Regulators are responsible for oversight and enforcements; AI developers and providers have

responsibilities under legislation. Organizations that use AI need to understand that their role and responsibility depending on their role. Cybersecurity professionals have interest in how AI connects to networks and new security risks. Everyday people matter as AI can affect their privacy, access to services, and decisions individuals make. These competing interests demonstrate why policies must consider both organizational responsibilities and public effect (Pasek, 2015).

Implications

The EU AI Act matters to cybersecurity as AI systems can gain access and interact with sensitive information, business applications, and organizational networks. If an AI tool has excessive permissions/ connects to an unsecure system, it can create backdoors and loopholes for unauthorized access and exposure. Companies need to know what AI tool they use and what systems and information that they have access to, and what the vendors do with that information. The policy itself connects to the conformation cycle discussed by Pasek (2015). AI systems involve information being created, processed, distributed, accessed, and used. Each stage cares concern involving piracy, security, and accesses. For instance, recently people have been using ai to create software that was previously behind a paywall. For technology companies, these concerns become a part of normal IT and cybersecurity responsibilities. However, this only applies to EU not America and the companies that only do business here.

Recommendation

I recommend that the companies begin reviewing their AI security practices instead of waiting for someone else to tell them to do so. They should create an inventory of every AI tool, what information it has access to, review vendor security practices, and determine whether any

activity falls under the EU AI Act's scope. Management may consider these unnecessary as the organization operates in United States. However, who not to say that the U.S. will not follow suit, as states like California has already introduced state laws governing AI transparency, employment uses, and frontier models. Another concern is the time and cost required, basic review is something that should happen either way not just cause of an Act.

References

Chee, F. Y. (2026, October 9). EU tech chief says bloc 'well equipped' to fend off rogue AI risk. Reuters. https://www.reuters.com/world/eu-tech-chief-says-bloc-well-equipped-fend-off-rogue-ai-risk-2026-10-09/

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APPENDIX A

Table 1. News Article Claim Check

Article claim	Related policy section	**Rating**	**Source chain**
The EU AI Act covers the whole life cycle of AI models.	Articles 9, 15, and 55	Oversimplified	Reuters → EU AI Act → Articles 9, 15, and 55
The European Commission requested information from more than 30 AI companies about their safety, security, transparency, and copyright practices.	Articles 91 and 92	Accurate as reported	Reuters → Commission's reported requests → EU AI Act enforcement provisions
Investigations could result in fines of up to 7% of a company's global annual turnover.	Articles 5 and 99	Oversimplified	Reuters → EU AI Act → Articles 5 and 99

Claim Check Explanations

Claim 1: The article reports that the EU AI Act covers the entire life cycle of AI models. This is an oversimplification because the Act addresses different stages of AI development and

use, but its requirements depend on the type of system and the organization's role. Article 9 establishes risk-management requirements for high-risk AI systems, Article 15 addresses their accuracy, robustness, and cybersecurity, and Article 55 establishes additional requirements for providers of general-purpose AI models with systemic risk.

Claim 2: Reuters reports that the European Commission requested information from more than 30 AI companies. This is accurate as a report of the Commission's activity according to the article. The regulation gives authorities powers to request information and documentation in specified circumstances. However, the article does not identify the companies, so the number and scope of the requests cannot be independently confirmed from the article alone.

Claim 3: The article's reference to fines of up to 7% is an oversimplification. Article 99(3) establishes the 7% maximum for violations of prohibited AI practices under Article 5. Other violations have different maximum penalties. Therefore, the 7% figure should not be interpreted as the maximum penalty for every violation or investigation.

Figure 1. Stakeholder Power and Impact Map

High power / lower direct impact

National EU governments: Help establish national enforcement arrangements and penalties. Their influence is significant, although their direct operational burden varies.

High power / high impact

European Commission and AI Office: Oversee and enforce parts of the Act and can request information, evaluate models, and take enforcement action.

AI model providers: May need to meet documentation, risk, evaluation, and security requirements depending on the model.

Low power / lower direct impact

Ridge IT Cyber: For this example, assume the organization has no relevant EU market activity or covered AI role. Its direct legal impact could be limited. This placement would change if its activities brought it within the Act's scope.

Low power / high impact

Members of the public: May experience the consequences of AI decisions but generally have limited influence over how systems are developed.

Organizations deploying AI: May need to change how they use covered AI systems, even though they do not control the law.

Cybersecurity professionals: May be responsible for security practices and monitoring without having authority over the legislation.

APPENDIX B

Annotated News Article

Article: Chee, F. Y. (2026, October 9). EU tech chief says bloc 'well equipped' to fend off rogue AI risk. Reuters.

Claim 1: The AI Act covers the whole life cycle of AI models.

Rating: Oversimplified

The article describes the Act as covering the entire life cycle of AI models. The legislation does address different stages of AI development and use. However, the requirements are not identical for every AI system. Article 9 addresses risk management for high-risk AI systems, Article 15 addresses their accuracy, robustness, and cybersecurity, and Article 55 establishes additional requirements for providers of general-purpose AI models with systemic risk. The article's statement is therefore a broad description rather than a complete explanation of the law.

Policy connection: Articles 9, 15, and 55.

“ "We have our AI Act in place and the AI Act covers the whole life cycle of these models," she added.”

Claim 2: The European Commission requested information from more than 30 AI companies about their safety, security, transparency, and copyright practices.

Rating: Accurate as reported

Reuters attributes this information to EU technology chief Henna Virkkunen. The article reports that the Commission sent requests in late August and was reviewing the companies' responses. The AI Act includes enforcement provisions that allow authorities to request information and documentation in specified circumstances. The article does not identify the companies, so the reported number and scope of the requests cannot be independently checked from the article alone.

Policy connection: Articles 91 and 92.

"The European Commission sent requests for information in late August to more than 30 AI companies asking for details of their safety and security measures and followed up with questions about their transparency and copyright obligations."

Claim 3: Investigations could result in fines of up to 7% of a company's global annual turnover.

Rating: Oversimplified

The article accurately identifies a maximum penalty found in the EU AI Act, but the statement needs additional context. Article 99(3) applies the 7% maximum to violations of prohibited AI practices under Article 5. Other violations have different penalty limits. Article

99(4) establishes a 3% maximum for certain other violations, while Article 101 establishes a separate penalty framework for general-purpose AI model providers. The 7% figure should not be understood as applying automatically to every company contacted by the Commission.

Policy connection: Articles 5, 99, and 101.

"Such requests can lead to investigations that could result in fines of as much as 7% of a company's global annual turnover."

APPENDIX C

Policy Section 1: Article 9 — Risk Management System

Plain-language summary: Article 9 requires providers of high-risk AI systems to establish and maintain a risk-management process. This process must identify potential risks, evaluate them, and establish measures to reduce or manage those risks throughout the system's lifecycle.

Impact tag: Risk management, safety, and accountability.

Stakeholder tag: AI system providers, regulators, and organizations involved in the development of high-risk AI systems.

Coverage flag: Covered. Reuters discusses the need to assess risks and evaluate AI models.

Ambiguity note: The article requires organizations to evaluate and manage risks, but determining what level of risk is acceptable may require technical judgment. Organizations may also need additional guidance when evaluating new or rapidly changing AI capabilities.

Policy Section 2: Article 15 — Accuracy, Robustness, and Cybersecurity

Plain-language summary: Article 15 requires high-risk AI systems to maintain appropriate accuracy, robustness, and cybersecurity throughout their lifecycle. It addresses threats such as data poisoning, model poisoning, adversarial examples, and confidentiality attacks.

Impact tag: Cybersecurity, system reliability, and information protection.

Stakeholder tag: AI providers, cybersecurity professionals, organizations deploying high-risk systems, and regulators.

Coverage flag: Covered. Reuters discusses safety, security, model evaluation, and continuous monitoring.

Ambiguity note: The article requires cybersecurity measures appropriate to the circumstances and risks. However, the specific technical measures needed may vary depending on the AI system, its purpose, and the threats it faces.

Policy Section 3: Article 55 — Obligations of Providers of General-Purpose AI Models with Systemic Risk

Plain-language summary: Article 55 establishes additional requirements for providers of general-purpose AI models with systemic risk. These include model evaluations, adversarial testing, assessment and mitigation of systemic risks, reporting serious incidents, and maintaining adequate cybersecurity protections.

Impact tag: AI safety, cybersecurity, incident reporting, and accountability.

Stakeholder tag: General-purpose AI model providers, the European Commission, the AI Office, and organizations relying on these models.

Coverage flag: Covered. Reuters discusses model evaluations, external experts, risk assessments, and continued monitoring.

Ambiguity note: The article applies to providers of general-purpose AI models with systemic risk, not every organization that uses AI. Determining whether a model meets the systemic-risk classification can require technical and regulatory assessment.

Redline Proposal — Article 15

Original wording excerpt: Article 15(5) requires technical solutions to address AI-specific vulnerabilities to be appropriate to the relevant circumstances and risks.

Proposed revision:

Technical solutions to address AI-specific vulnerabilities shall be ~~appropriate to the relevant circumstances and the risks~~ based on a documented assessment of the system's intended use, identified vulnerabilities, potential threats, and the consequences of a successful attack. Providers shall review and update these protections when significant vulnerabilities or changes in the system are identified.

Reason for proposed change: The original language allows flexibility, but it does not specify how providers should document their decisions or when protections should be reviewed. The proposed wording would make the expectations clearer by connecting security measures to documented risk assessments and updates when systems or threats change. It would also help cybersecurity professionals understand how to evaluate whether protections are appropriate.